

Global Scout – Player Identity Linking & Verification

Executive Summary

Global Scout intends to display player statistics sourced from a third-party sports data provider. To do this, each player account must be linked to the correct player profile within the external data source.

The primary challenge is identity matching. We cannot rely solely on information entered by the user, nor can we expect users to locate and provide their own third-party player identifier.

This proposal outlines a user-friendly, scalable process that combines automated matching with human verification to ensure accuracy while maintaining a smooth onboarding experience.

Goals

Business Goals

- Allow players to quickly connect their Global Scout profile to their official statistics.
- Minimize onboarding friction.
- Prevent fraudulent profile claims.
- Maintain high confidence in player identity data.
- Support future growth without requiring complex integrations with external providers.

User Experience Goals

- Do not require users to know or provide third-party player IDs.
 - Present likely matches automatically.
 - Make the verification process clear and transparent.
 - Allow users to continue using the platform while verification is pending.
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Proposed Solution

The solution consists of two stages:

1. Automated Player Matching
 2. Manual Verification Review
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Stage 1: Automated Player Matching

Information Collected During Registration

During account creation, players will provide:

- Full Name
- Date of Birth
- Nationality
- Current Club
- Previous Club (optional)
- Position
- League / Competition (optional)

This information is already valuable for profile creation and does not introduce significant onboarding friction.

External Player Search

Once registration is complete, Global Scout will search the third-party sports database for potential matches.

The system will not expose third-party identifiers to the user.

Instead, it will display potential player profiles using information such as:

- Player Name
- Club
- Position
- Nationality
- Age
- Profile Photo (if available)

Example:

We found possible matches

Player A

- FC Barcelona
- Midfielder
- Age 21

Player B

- FC Barcelona B
- Midfielder
- Age 21

Player C

- Real Zaragoza
- Midfielder
- Age 21

The user selects the profile that appears to represent them.

Confidence Score Matching

To identify likely matches, the system will calculate a confidence score.

Example Matching Factors

Factor	Weight
Exact Name Match	High
Date of Birth Match	Very High
Current Club Match	High
Previous Club Match	Medium
Nationality Match	Medium
Position Match	Medium
Age Match	Medium
League Match	Low

Example Confidence Levels

High Confidence (90%+)

The system is highly confident there is a single correct match.

Example:

- Exact name match
- Date of birth match
- Current club match

User is shown one recommended profile.

Medium Confidence (60%-90%)

Multiple possible matches exist.

The user is shown several candidates and selects one.

Low Confidence (<60%)

The system cannot confidently identify a match.

The user may:

- Provide additional information
 - Submit a manual claim
 - Request administrator assistance
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Stage 2: Manual Verification

Selecting a profile does not immediately establish trust.

Instead, a player claim is created.

Status: Pending Verification

At this stage:

- The player account is linked provisionally.
 - Statistics may be displayed with an "Unverified" label.
 - The account cannot receive a verified badge.
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Verification Submission

The player submits evidence supporting their claim.

Accepted evidence may include:

- Official team roster listing
 - Federation registration card
 - Club-issued identification
 - Official player profile URL
 - Public social media account associated with the player
 - Other supporting documentation
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Administrator Review

Global Scout administrators review:

- Submitted evidence
- Confidence score
- External player profile
- Existing platform records

The administrator then:

Approves

Result:

- Mapping becomes verified.
- Verified badge is awarded.
- Statistics become trusted platform data.

Rejects

Result:

- Claim is denied.
- Player may submit a new claim.

Request More Information

Result:

- Claim remains pending.
 - User receives instructions for additional evidence.
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Verification States

Status	Description
Unmatched	No external player found
Suggested	Potential matches identified
Claimed	Player selected a profile
Pending Verification	Awaiting admin review
Verified	Claim approved
Rejected	Claim denied

Benefits

High Accuracy

Combines automated matching with human review.

Low User Friction

Players never need to find external IDs themselves.

Fraud Prevention

Users cannot self-verify.

Scalable

Most users will be matched automatically, allowing administrators to focus only on verification decisions.

Provider Agnostic

The process works with any sports data provider and can support multiple providers in the future.

Future Enhancements

The following improvements can be added later if needed:

Club Verification

Club administrators can verify player identities.

Federation Verification

National federations can confirm player ownership.

Social Verification

Users can verify ownership through connected social accounts.

Automated Trust Scoring

Verified clubs and federations can increase confidence scores and reduce manual review workload.

Recommended Initial Implementation

Phase 1 should include:

- Automated player search
- Confidence score calculation
- Player profile selection
- Evidence upload
- Manual administrator approval workflow
- Verified player status

This approach provides the best balance between user experience, implementation effort, and data integrity for the initial launch of Global Scout.